

JavaScript RegExp Objects

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The RegExp Object

The `RegExp` object is used to search for patterns in strings. It can be created with literal syntax `/pattern/` or `new RegExp()` :

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<body>

<h2>JavaScript RegExp Objects</h2>
<p>From w3schools.com, Experiment by Teeratus_R</p>

<h4>The RegExp Object</h4>
<p id="demo"></p>

<script>
// Literal syntax
const pattern1 = /hello/;

// Constructor syntax
const pattern2 = new RegExp("hello");

let text = "Literal pattern: " + pattern1 + "<br>";
text += "Constructor pattern: " + pattern2 + "<br><br>";
text += "Both are RegExp objects: " + (pattern1 instanceof RegExp) + "<br>";
text += "with global flag: " + /hello/g.global;

document.getElementById("demo").innerHTML = text;
</script>

</body>
</html>
```

Example 1

Result [View Example](#)

Using test()

The `test()` method searches a string for a pattern match. It returns `true` or `false` :

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<body>

<h2>JavaScript RegExp Objects</h2>
<p>From w3schools.com, Experiment by Teeratus_R</p>

<h4>Using test()</h4>
<p id="demo"></p>

<script>
const text = "The rain in Spain";

// test() returns boolean
const result1 = /ain/.test(text);
const result2 = /xyz/.test(text);

document.getElementById("demo").innerHTML =
  "Text: " + text + "<br><br>" +
  "test(/ain/): " + result1 + " (found)<br>" +
  "test(/xyz/): " + result2 + " (not found)<br><br>" +
  "test() returns true or false";
</script>

</body>
</html>
```

Example 2

Result [View Example](#)

Using exec()

The `exec()` method searches for a match and returns the match details (or `null`):

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<body>

<h2>JavaScript RegExp Objects</h2>
<p>From w3schools.com, Experiment by Teeratus_R</p>

<h4>Using exec()</h4>
<p id="demo"></p>

<script>
const text = "The rain in Spain";

// exec() returns match details
const result = /ain/.exec(text);

document.getElementById("demo").innerHTML =
  "Text: " + text + "<br><br>" +
  "exec(/ain/):<br>" +
  "match[0]: " + result[0] + "<br>" +
  "index: " + result.index + "<br>" +
  "input: " + result.input;
</script>

</body>
</html>
```

Example 3

Result [View Example](#)

The RegExp.escape() Method

`RegExp.escape()` escapes special characters in a string so it can be used as a literal pattern:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<body>

<h2>JavaScript RegExp Objects</h2>
<p>From w3schools.com, Experiment by Teeratus_R</p>

<h4>The RegExp.escape() Method</h4>
<p id="demo"></p>

<script>
let text = "";

if (RegExp.escape) {
  // Escape special characters
  const escaped = RegExp.escape("a.b*c");
  text += "RegExp.escape('a.b*c'): " + escaped + "<br><br>";

  // Use escaped pattern to match literal dots and stars
  const result = "a.b*c".match(new RegExp(escaped));
  text += "Matching literal 'a.b*c': " + result[0];
} else {
  text += "RegExp.escape() is not supported in this browser yet.";
}

document.getElementById("demo").innerHTML = text;
</script>

</body>
</html>
```

Example 4

Result [View Example](#)

Document

Document in project

You can [Download PDF](#) file.

Reference

- [W3Schools JavaScript RegExp Objects](#)